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RAMADAN 3, 1446

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4 killed, aid halted amid Gaza impasse

ISRAEL HAD BACKED TRUCE EXTENSION TO BEYOND THE END OF RAMADAN

GAZA CITY

Israel said yesterday that it was suspending the entry of supplies into Gaza, with artillery fire and an air strike reported in the territory after it and Hamas hit an impasse over how to proceed with their fragile ceasefire.

The ministry of health in Gaza said four people were killed and six others wounded in Israeli attacks yesterday after the first phase of a fragile truce in the territory drew to a close. "Since this morning, four dead and six wounded" have been brought to "hospitals in the Gaza Strip following Israeli attacks in various parts of the territory", the ministry said in a statement.

As the 42-day first phase of the ceasefire drew to a close, Israel gave its backing to an extension it said was put forward by US Middle East envoy Steve Witkoff, which would cover the Muslim fasting month of Ramadan and the Jewish holiday of Passover.

Hamas has repeatedly rejected an extension, instead favouring a transition to the truce deal's second phase, which would see the release of all remaining hostages and a more permanent end to the

Hamas favours a transition to the truce deal's second phase, which would see the release of all remaining hostages and a more permanent end to the fighting in Gaza.

fighting in the war-ravaged Gaza Strip. Following the announcement of the aid suspension, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's spokesman Omer Dostru wrote on X: "No trucks entered Gaza this morning, nor will they at this stage."

Hamas slammed the move, saying in a statement that the "decision to suspend humanitarian aid is cheap blackmail, a war crime and a blatant coup against the (ceasefire) agreement".

Egypt's Foreign Minister Badr Abdelatty urged the "full implementation" of the Gaza ceasefire deal, calling on the European Union to pressure Israel to enforce it. UN chief Antonio Guterres also called on Israel to end its suspension of humanitarian aid to Gaza "immediately."

SEE ALSO P11



Ahmad Alotbi/Gulf News

CANNON FIRED AT BURJ KHALIFA TO MARK IFTAR

People gather to watch the cannon firing marking iftar at Burj Khalifa yesterday. The UAE marked the start of Ramadan on Saturday. Cannons are traditionally fired at sunset to announce Iftar, which marks the end of the day's fast during Ramadan.

SEE ALSO P3

Dubai areas to see 70% cut in travel time

RTA inks Dh6b deal with Dubai Holding for major upgrades

DUBAI

BY SHARMILA DHAL
UAE Editor

It's good news for Dubai motorists as entry and exit to several areas in the city are set to become easier. There are many infrastructural upgrades being made in other areas too. The result: A 30-70 per cent cut in commute time. This follows a Dh6 billion agreement signed

between the Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) of Dubai and Dubai Holding.

Improving access points

The agreement covers infrastructural upgrades in a number of areas. Among them are Dubai Islands, Jumeirah Village Triangle, Palm Gateway, Al Furjan, Jumeirah Park, Arjan, Majan, Liwan (Phase 1), Nad Al Hamar, Villanova, and Serena. As part of the deal, bridges and roads will also be developed to improve access points for five key Dubai Holding developments: Jumeirah Village Circle, Dubai Pro-

duction City, Business Bay, Palm Jumeirah, and International City (Phase 3).

Shaikh Ahmad Bin Saeed Al Maktoum, Chairman of Dubai Holding, who witnessed the signing of the agreement between Mattar Al Tayer, Director General, Chairman of the Board of Executive Directors of RTA, and Amit Kaushal, Group Chief Executive Officer of Dubai Holding, said, "This strategic partnership with RTA reflects our shared vision of a city that is not only innovative but also seamlessly accessible."

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Eid travel rush to send UAE airfares soaring 40% to 50% | P6

INDIA

Eight dead in Uttarakhand avalanche as rescue efforts end | P13

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